

T H U R S D A Y

KINDNESS AND GOODNESS:

FRUITS OF LOVE

*"But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience,
kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control;
against such things there is no law."*

Galatians 5:22, 23

Let's learn about fruit from around the World:

GUAVA

Guava has a somewhat thick, green or yellow skin with pink on the inside. It is distinguished by a sweet and somewhat gritty texture. It is known as a tropical fruit that is native to Latin America including Mexico, Central America, the Northern Caribbean and South America.

Guavas contain four times more fiber than a pineapple and four times more vitamin C than an orange. Guavas have a high level of an ingredient called pectin, so it is used extensively to make candies, jams, jellies, and marmalade. In South America you'll find guavas at family gatherings often offered by the host as an appetizer with cheese and crackers.



TODAY'S SPIRITUAL FRUIT ARE

KINDNESS AND GOODNESS

Galatians 5:22 and 23 reads: “But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, **kindness, goodness**, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control; against such things there is no law.”

Kindness is the quality of being generous, considerate, and friendly. There are many ways to practice kindness such as opening a door, sharing food with someone who is hungry, helping someone carry a heavy load, or simply sharing a smile.

In Ephesians 4:31, 32, the Apostle Paul teaches the essence of kindness to the members of the church at Ephesus when he shares: “All bitterness, wrath, anger, clamor, and slander must be removed from you, along with all malice. Be kind to one another, compassionate, forgiving each other, just as God in Christ also has forgiven you.”

Here Paul is speaking to believers who are Jews and Gentiles, equally claiming to be a part of the family of God. As such, Paul reminds them, their family relationships should be informed by the values of God’s kingdom. This means putting away five sins in all of their relationships: bitterness, wrath, anger, clamor, and slander. Malice must also be removed. And replace these repulsive behaviors with kindness, compassion, and forgiveness. Since this is the way God behaves with us—Paul goes on to say—you should also behave this way with one another. These deeds, including kindness, are meant to build up families and develop unity in the body of Christ.

Jesus practiced kindness every day in a very bold and radical way for His time. His kindness often extended to the “least of these”,

people who were not treated so well in society. He healed lepers, cast out demons from those who were possessed, and fed people who were hungry.

As for the virtue of goodness, it literally means godliness—to be like God—holy, pure, and righteous. Just like kindness, a pure heart is required to cultivate the fruit of goodness. Daily we are to exhibit the goodness (godliness) of Christ as Psalms 23:6 says, “Certainly goodness and mercy will follow me all the days of my life, and my dwelling will be in the house of the Lord forever.” Goodness is about having the character of Christ. Of course, goodness is not just doing kind or good acts—practicing goodness needs to become a way of life.

Speaking about people who would exhibit these qualities in their lives, Ellen White said: “All who became the subjects of Christ’s kingdom, he said, would give evidence of faith and repentance. Kindness, honesty, and fidelity would be seen in their lives...So the followers of Christ will give evidence of the transforming power of the Holy Spirit” (*The Desire of Ages*, p. 107).

Being transformed by God’s Spirit is what being a Christian is all about. So, today, choose to water the fruit of kindness and goodness in your hearts and in your homes. As you share a smile or words of encouragement with family members, neighbors, coworkers and friends, may everyone recognize that you are “walking in the Spirit” (v. 16) rather than living by “the desires of the flesh” (v. 17), because the Spirit of God lives in you.

PRAY:

Dear Heavenly Father, You are so loving, kind and good to us each day. Help us to be loving, kind and good to one another every opportunity we get. In the name of Jesus, amen.



FRUITFUL **GOODNESS** ACTIVITY

You will need:

- Some good fruit or vegetables and some bad fruit or vegetables
- Plate and knife

Instructions:

- Cut open the good and bad fruit and vegetables.
- Look at them carefully. What is the difference between the good and the bad ones?
- Can you always tell, just by looking on the outside, if something is good or bad?
- Would you like to taste the bad ones?
- What can you learn about human goodness from looking at these fruits and vegetables?
- What's the most important message for you, today, as you think about good and bad fruits?
- The good news is that, even though we can't make the bad fruit good, God is completely and always good. He always forgives us when we are bad, and wants to help us be good, because He knows we will be much happier when we make good choices and develop good characters.
- Prepare the good fruits for eating, and bury the bad fruit in the ground, where it can turn to good soil and help other things to grow.

BIBLE VERSE ACTIVITY

- Work together as a family to create some actions for kindness and goodness. Practice your actions together and then teach Galatians 5:22,23 bible verse to another family at church or in your neighborhood.

FRUITFUL **KINDNESS** ACTIVITY

You will need:

- Paper and pens or pencils

Instructions:

- Ask everyone to draw around their hand on a sheet of paper.
- On the palm of the hand outline write about a time someone was especially kind to you. What did they do and how did their kindness make you feel?
- On each finger write one thing you could do to be kind to someone else in the next week.
- Take it in turns to talk about the times someone was especially kind to you.
- Then read all the kindness ideas that you wrote on your hands.
- Talk about how you can work together to do these acts of kindness.
- Did you know that being kind to others is one of the best ways to feel happy yourself?
- Do something kind for someone in your community. Work together as a family to bake bread, purchase groceries, or tidy their garden.

— **QUESTIONS** — TO TALK ABOUT TOGETHER

- I think kindness is...
- The kindest thing anyone ever did for me was...
- Kindness is important in relationships because...
- Kindness is a fruit of the Spirit because...
- Jesus was especially kind to others when He...
- One time that I tried to be kind this week was when...
- We can help each other to be kind by...
- I think goodness is...
- Goodness is a fruit of the Spirit because...
- Jesus showed us how to be good when He...
- Other Bible characters who showed goodness were...
- I find it hardest to be good when...
- Some things that help me to be good are...
- One time that I tried to be good this week was when...
- We can help each other to be good by...
- Pray: Thank You, God, for helping us to be kind and good this week...